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மத்திய சுற்றாடல் அதிகாரசபை

Central Environmental Authority

“පරිසර පියස”, 104, ඩෙන්සිල් කොබ්බෑකඩුව මාවත, බත්තරමුල්ල, ශ්‍රී ලංකාව

“பரிசர பியச”, 104, டென்சில் கொப்பேகடுவ மாவத்தை, பத்தரமுல்லை, இலங்கை

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எமது தொடர்பு
Our Ref.

08/EIA/P&E/19/2024

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உமது தொடர்பு
Your Ref.



29 August 2025

Director General

Coast Conservation and Coastal Resource Management Dept.

No. 556, New Secretariat

Maligawatta

Colombo 10.

PROPOSED ENVISION DUTCH BAY 150 MW + 23.8 BESS RENEWABLE ENERGY WIND POWER PROJECT, KALPITIYA

This has reference to the draft EIA report dated June 2025 and to the Technical Evaluation Committee meeting held on 15.07.2025 at your Department regarding the above project.

We describe below our observations on inadequacies/areas to be amended in the above draft EIA report as Annexure 1.

G R D N

G R D N K Attanayake

Director (EIA)

Environmental Management & Assessment Division

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Chapter 1 : Introduction

- **Water Quality Measurements**

- The water quality measurements need to be done covering both wet and dry seasons.

However, the report has provided data related to samples collected in one season and also the particular season has not been specified.

Also, T8 shows high oil & grease content.

- **Approvals/consents from the relevant government agencies.**

Necessary approval/consents required to be obtained for the project have not been obtained as per ToR.

Eg :

- Department of Wildlife Conservation.
- Sri Lanka Tourism Development Authority
- Department of Fisheries & Aquatic Resources
- Urban Development Authority
- Divisional Secretary – Kalpitiya and
- Pradeshiya Sabawa-Kalpitiya

Chapter 2 : Description of the Proposed Project and Reasonable Alternatives

- **Project layout plan**

The project layout plan covering all the project component has not been given in the report.

Accordingly, project layout plan covering the entire project area including all major components (wind towers, internal power collective system, transmission line, access road and other related structures such as collector substation, switch yards, Battery Energy Storage System (BESS), residential area, fishing boat landing sites, kitesurfing locations, areas where tourism activities are ongoing and any identified for other utility and other structures) of the project, related structures etc. and reservation areas, required to be annexed with the report.



- **Details of land ownership of the project**

The land requirement of the project has been calculated based only on the project footprint and it is 0.7 ha for a wind tower.

However, during the construction of the wind tower, the required land extent will be greater than the above, as the tower-erecting machinery needs to be stationed at the site for installation of blades of which the length is 80 m.

Therefore, the required land extent needs to be assessed considering the hardstand area and other requirements of a wind tower.

- **Storm Water Drainage Plan**

Existing storm water drainage path together with the proposed storm water drainage plan have to be included in the report covering the entire project area. The areas where indicating natural drainage pattern / pathway to be improved due installation of towers and obstruction that can be experienced in construction phase. Both construction and operational phases to be addressed in preparation of the Drainage Management Plan.

- **Avifauna Detecting Mechanism**

A Bird and Bat Repellent System has been proposed in the EIA report for implementation of the project and the health and safety considerations of this system, given as follows in the report:

- The bird repellent system must be turned off in advance when site personnel are working.
- High-decibel phonetics and ultrasounds can negatively affect human health; therefore, the installation should be located away from populated areas.

It is required to pay attention on the practicability of the above facts, since the proposed area is having a tourist attraction and also usage actively by fishing community for daily activities and accordingly, any harmful effect due to bird-repelling system will be affected adversely on such land users of the area. Instead, based on the detailed bird study, suitable tower locations and the most practical bird detection system have to be selected.

- **Internal transmission lines**

- Some details of the internal transmission line have not been indicated in the report.

Eg : The total length, trace the proposed transmission lines,



- The number of trees envisaged to be removed during construction of internal line.

Chapter 3 : Description of the Existing Environment

• Water Quality

It has been identified the residents in the proposed region primarily rely on dug wells and rainwater harvesting systems. However, the following details have not been given in the report.

- The availability of dug wells / No. of wells with GPS coordinate and the water levels of each well in the project influenced area together with number of families using the particular well.
- BOD & COD levels of surface and groundwater in the area as baseline data in addition to the data indicated in Table 3.2.

• Ecological Study and Avifauna Study of the Project

It is noted that the following facts have been highlighted in the EIA report related avifauna / studies related avifauna.

- "The project's proximity to the Puttalam Lagoon, a critical habitat for migratory birds and marine life, necessitates careful planning to mitigate environmental impacts. Sensitive ecosystems, including mangroves and seagrass beds, are located near the project area".
- "Avifauna surveys were conducted from April 22nd to 25th, 2025, covering the end of the 2024/2025 migratory season".
- "Due to the short duration of the study and unfavorable weather conditions, detailed identification of flight paths and quantification of movement density were not carried out. As a result, further long-term observations under stable weather conditions are recommended to accurately assess flight patterns and potential risks, especially with turbine placement".
- "Heavy rains and cloudy conditions were experienced during the survey period; therefore, the recorded number of species and individual birds may not fully represent the actual avifaunal diversity in the area".



Finally, following has been recommended in the ecological study.

“Further long-term observations under stable weather conditions are recommended to accurately assess flight patterns and potential risks, especially in relation to turbine placement.”

Based on the above details and the recommendations given in the EIA report, it is evident that the area is highly sensitive to migratory avifauna species. However, a detailed one-year avifauna study, covering both daytime and nighttime movements, has not been conducted.

Therefore, in line with the findings of the ecological survey in the EIA report, it is strongly recommended itself that the most suitable turbine locations have to be selected only after completing a detailed one-year avifauna study.

- **Ecological assessment of the project impacts area.**

As per the details given in the tables under the section 3.3.8.1, it has described that the area proposed to locate the WT -1 comprises scattered water bodies with fringing mangroves that occur within the wind turbine's rotational zone and the rotating area of WT 6 overlaps with the lagoon on the eastern side, where fringing mangroves line the lagoon edge.

As per common understanding, an extent of 2.56 ha of vegetation will need to be cleared for the installation of a wind turbine. Since mangroves are a highly sensitive habitat, this needs to be carefully taken into consideration during project planning.

- **Overlapping with the proposed development plans.**

According to section 3.5.5 of the EIA report Sri Lanka Tourism Development Authority has developed a zoning plan specifically for “Kitesurfing area” in the Kalpitiya. The turbine number T-13, T-14 and T- 15 are appearing as overlap with the “kitesurfing area” of the above plane.

Therefore, Sri Lanka Tourism Development Authority concerns need to be obtained.



Chapter 4 : Anticipated Environmental Impacts of the Proposed Project

- Impacts on dwellers, the fishing community, fishing activities and the security point due to noise.
 - The predicted noise levels from the turbine is mentioned as 60 dB(A) at 100 meters and 55 dB(A) at 300 meters distance from the tower location. However, a measurement in between 100 m and 300 m distances have not been obtained. This measurement is required to get an idea about the noise level in that area.
 - It has mentioned, that no special mitigation measures are required to mitigate the noise generation during the operation phase. However, the noise level to be determined for the receptors who resided in 160 m distance to the wind towers as indicated above, to decide the adoption of mitigation measures.

- **Ecological Impacts**

It has given in this section that each turbine site, approximately 0.2 ha. of vegetation, including trees and shrubs, will be cleared for construction.

The impact area due to the construction a wind turbine will be more than 2.5 ha. with the proposed turbine configuration. Ecological impacts due to clearing lands for the tower erection need to be further studied.

In addition to the above, the impacts on the habitat of fauna species will be higher when considering the actual land clearing area of a wind tower, and this also needs to be indicated correctly.

- **Impacts on bird migration**

The impact levels of each tower have been categorized in Section 4.5.5 of the report, showing that the T1 has a highest impact level. However, it is unclear which scientific method was adopted to evaluate the impact levels of the wind turbines in the absence of a detailed bird / avifauna study. Therefore, this needs to be clarified.

It has further been indicated in the section that, to accurately assess the long-term effects of turbine operation on migratory birds, it is essential to conduct continuous, year-round monitoring.



Accordingly, the findings of the EIA study, the EIA report itself may not be acceptable as a proper avifauna study has not been done since it is one of the critical and limiting factor related wind power project.

Therefore, as recommended, the wind tower arrangement needs to be finalized based on the finding of a detailed bird avifauna study and collision risk analysis.

- **Anticipated impacts of siltation**

It is noted that, some impacts have not been addressed in the report.

Eg :

- Siltation impacts during dewatering, land stability/ground collapses land clearing, excavation and construction etc., have to be discussed adequately.
- Impacts on ground water table due to intrusion of saline water during the tower construction.

Chapter 5 : Proposed Mitigatory Measures

- **Proposed Minimization measures for habitat loss**

In the section 5.4.1 of the report has been recommended to carry an out detailed baseline ecological surveys and geospatial mapping to avoid impacts on precious habitats such as native coastal scrublands, grasslands, mangroves, and seasonal wetlands such as salt marshes.

However, the project foot print required to be established based on the finding of detailed baseline ecological surveys (including bird / avifauna study) and geospatial mapping

- **The mitigatory measures for some impacts have not been discussed in the report.**

Eg :

- Potential noise impacts during the operational phase.
- Reduction of groundwater table (quality & quantity) and availability of groundwater for the users of the project-impacted area due to construction of wind towers.



Chapter 6 : Environmental Management and Monitoring Programme

Monitoring methods to investigate the reduction of ground water / well water quantity as well as water quality have not been included.

- Contradictory statements indicated in the report need to be rectified.

Eg :

1. Section 2.2.2.1 states that approximately 3 ha. of vegetation will be cleared for the erection of wind turbines. It is also mentioned that the total land area required for the wind turbine footprint and access roads is 13 ha, with approximately 0.7 ha allocated for the turbine footprints.
2. Section 2.4.4.1 estimates that 497 m³ of water will be needed during construction, while Section 2.4.4.2 ambiguously states that the water requirement is "limited" and not mentioned the volume required."
3. Section 2.2.3.4 indicates that dedicated dumping sites will not be required, as all remaining spoils will be reused. Conversely, Section 2.2.2.1 mentions that balance disposal materials will be returned to the environment for on-site or off-site disposal. If on-site disposal is planned, such areas must be identified and included in the EIA report.
4. Table 2.2, wind energy resource analysis has been conducted assuming a hub height as 130 m. However, the proposed plant will have turbines with a hub height of 140 m and accordingly the assessment has to be carried out considering correct values.
5. Section 4.5 states that approximately 0.2 ha of vegetation, including trees and shrubs, will be cleared at each turbine site for construction. This is to be reconciled with the overall land and vegetation requirements as mentioned.

6. General

- Some maps attached to the EIA report are not legible.

Eg : Figure 3.6, Figure 3.7, Figure 3.33

- The necessary details have not been given in the annexures.

Eg : Distances from the project boundary to each location selected for the measurement of noise levels.

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